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Joseph Tarlin, a 2021 Natick High School graduate, starred in hockey, lacrosse, and cross country for the RedHawks.

Natick's Joseph Tarlin Made His Mark Across Three Sports for the RedHawks

NATICK, Mass. — Joseph Tarlin, a 2021 graduate of Natick High School, built a decorated three-sport athletic career for the RedHawks, earning statewide recognition on the ice, helping lead the lacrosse program to new heights, and competing four varsity years for the cross-country team. He then moved on to the University of Wisconsin Madison, where he majored in political science and criminal justice.

A defenseman for Natick's varsity hockey team for three seasons, Tarlin also saw regular time on the power play and penalty kill. He was ranked among the state's top players by Massachusetts Official Neutral Zone, coming in at No. 64 during the 2019-20 season and climbing to No. 56 the following year. Tarlin posted 12 points in 19 games during the 2019-20 campaign and followed with 15 points in 21 games in 2020-21, helping the RedHawks earn the No. 1 ranking in MIAA Division 1 that season before falling in the second round of the state tournament. He played for head coach Bill LaCouture Jr, a former NHL player and Natick High School legend, whose career was cut short by injuries.

On the lacrosse field, Tarlin spent two seasons as a defensive short-stick midfielder, contributing on Natick's man-down unit. He was part of the squad that advanced further in the state tournament than any team in program history, reaching the semifinals. He played under head coach Nate Kittler, who helped found the Natick High School lacrosse program in the 1990s.

Tarlin also competed four years on varsity cross country, running the 5-kilometer and 2-mile distances for head coach Matthew Miller. He posted personal-best times of 17:30 in the 5K and 11:20 in the 2-mile over his high school career. Natick High School is located in Natick, Massachusetts, just west of Boston.

While much of his athletic success came during his junior and senior seasons, Tarlin excelled just as much in the classroom, graduating with a 4.40 GPA. Athletics run in the Tarlin family. His father, Michael Tarlin, has coached high school basketball in Massachusetts for more than 25 years and won a division 1 state championship as an assistant coach at Catholic Memorial in 2015. Michael Tarlin also directs the Special Olympics program at Framingham High School and volunteers with the Challenger Baseball League for individuals with special needs. Joseph's mother, Janet Tarlin, has supported the family throughout his athletic career. His younger brother Danny, now 21, captained the Natick High School basketball team in 2023 and currently practices with the University of Pittsburgh women's basketball team.